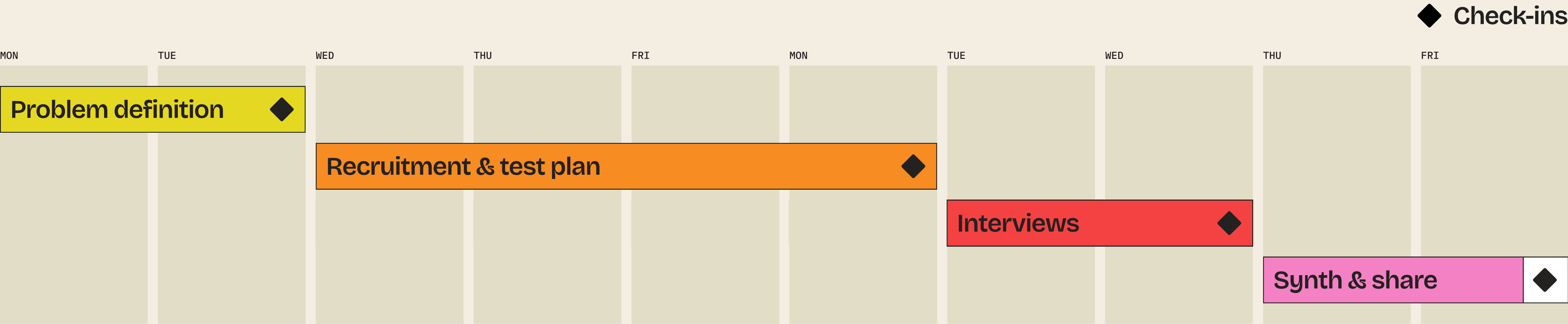


HIA | Race for Impact: Fundraiser Research

01	Background
02	Testing approach
03	Learnings
04	Next steps

A 2-week project plan.



Problem definition

Speak to people internally, review existing work, and define the problem we’re solving.

Recruitment & test plan

Secure testers, define key assumptions, and shape them into a test.

Interviews

Run the testing, record sessions, and build the evidence base.

Synth & share

Summarise the insights, assign evidence, and present back the findings.

Sole researcher and strategist. Engaged directly by High Impact Athletes.

WHAT I DID

■ Scoped the project with the client

■ Synthesised previous research

■ Analysed a body of fundraiser-written page copy to derive the connection levers

■ Defined the key audience groups

■ Set the learning goals and wrote the assumption set

■ Built an interactive prototype with toggleable content blocks for live testing

■ Recruited participants and ran all five sessions

■ Wrote testing scripts

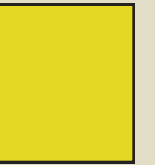
■ Ran all 5 testing sessions

■ Synthesised the findings and wrote the design principles

■ Summarised the project in a strategy deck and presented to HIA team

01

Background



HIA came to me with a wording question: should we express impact as years of depression averted, or lives improved?

To answer it, I needed to understand what fundraisers were seeing in their sign up journey and how they were processing the content. So I went and asked them.

It turned out most of them had never seen the page the question was about.

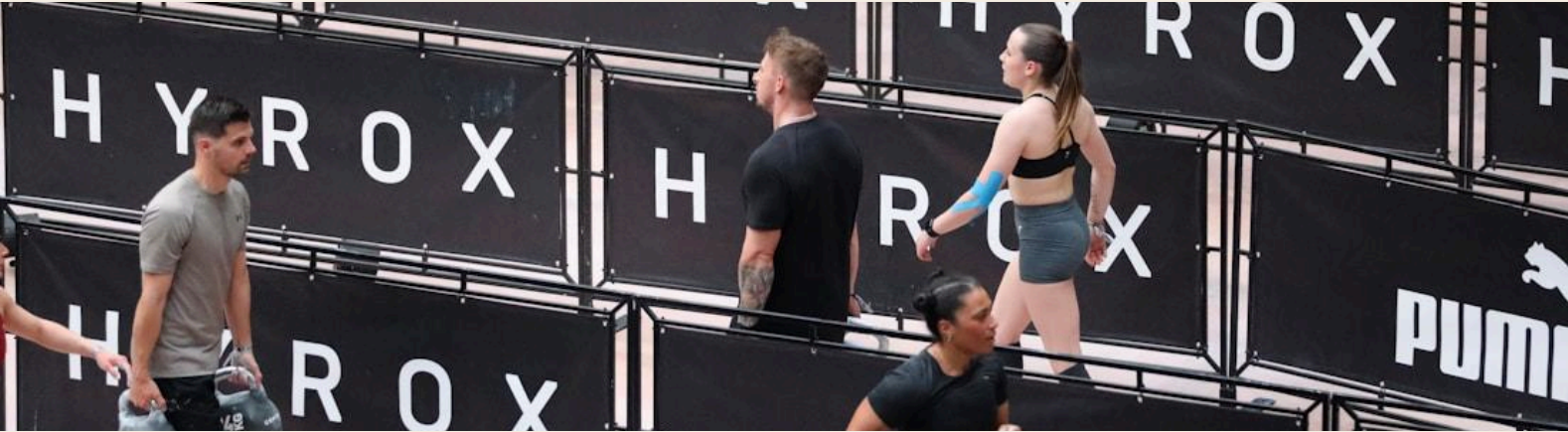
HIA leads the way in mass-activating people to fundraise for effective organisations.

Race for Impact is the partnership with HYROX: racers buy a charity ticket and commit to fundraising for one of five HIA-vetted cause funds — Global Health, Mental Health, Women's Empowerment, Animal Welfare and Climate Solutions.

For most racers, this is their first encounter with these charities, their first encounter with effective giving, and often their first time fundraising at all.

Racers are being asked to raise money for organisations they've never heard of, chosen on grounds they've never come across. That's a harder ask than most fundraising.

Two things have to hold: **Trust** and **Connection**.



Trust

Do they believe in what they've signed up to?

Connection

Do they care about it enough to go and ask people for money?

Connection is built by specific levers — and we can identify which ones.

There are seven candidates, drawn from analysing what fundraisers write on their own pages:

Personal driver

Because of a personal reason, which they attach to the closest-matching cause

Inspiration / legacy

Because they want to inspire their children, or in memory of someone

Privilege / gratitude

Because they recognise their own advantage

Athleticism link

Because they see the link between their training / race and the cause

Problem empathy

Because they resonate with the scale & severity of the problem

Impact / effectiveness

Because they resonate with the outcomes and impact they'll have

Local → global

Because they recognise the problem locally, and can empathise with it globally

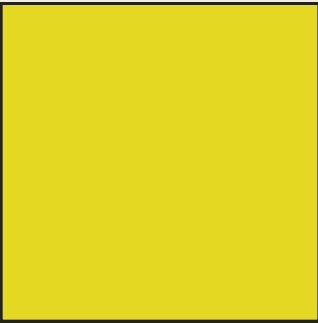


Understand what racers actually respond to, and use it deliberately.

Not just on the cause page, but across every communication HIA has with a fundraiser: the RFI and HYROX sites, onboarding and welcome comms, fundraising set-up, and celebration comms once they've raised.

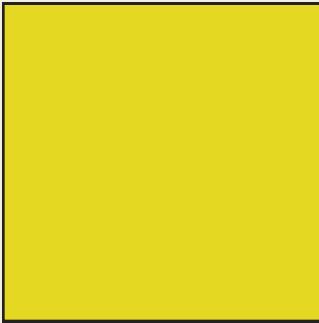
The goal is a set of principles HIA can apply to any communication with a fundraiser – rather than a one-off fix to a single page – which can then be extended to donors as well.

Four groups, defined by what gets them to a cause:



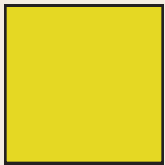
Evidence-led

Choose on the strength of the evidence: cost-per-outcome, vetting, the case that this charity does more good per dollar. The proof of impact is the reason; nothing else needs surfacing for them.



Story-led

Arrive with a strong personal reason already in hand: something they've lived through, someone they've lost, or a sense of their own good fortune. They attach it to whichever cause fits closest. The match is sometimes precise, often just close enough.



Persuadable

No / weak personal reason, and not drawn in by effectiveness either, but haven't switched off from the charity aspect. This is the group everything here is designed to reach. The open question is what gives them a reason to care, not whether they're willing to.



Disengaged

Not engaged with the charity side at all. Often people who didn't realise what they'd signed up for. Out of scope: their problem is comms and UI clarity at the point of purchase, not connection to a cause.

02

Testing approach

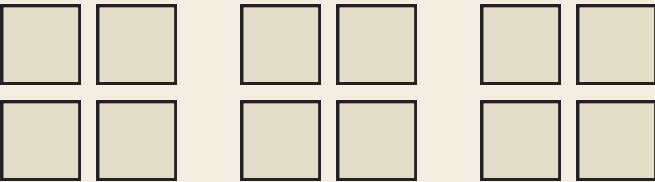


Turn what we believe into what we can test. Assumptions become questions, questions become something a racer can look at, and reactions to that give us evidence rather than opinion.



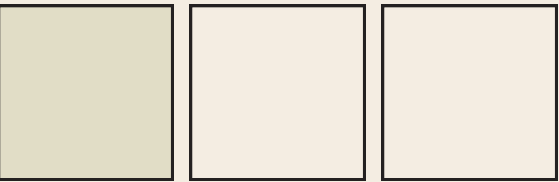
List assumptions

Write down the key things we believe but can't prove.



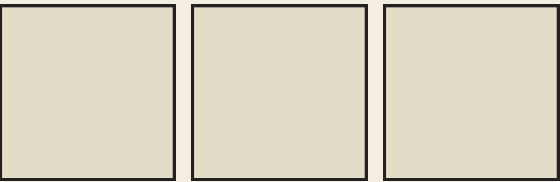
Group into learning goals

Cluster the assumptions into the main questions we're trying to answer.



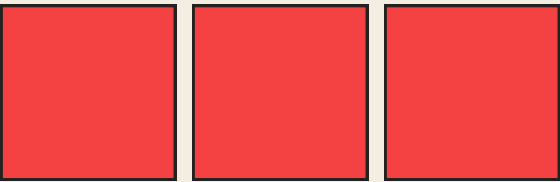
Structure into a test

Understand what's needed to test the key assumptions and connect the tests into one seamless flow.



Build missing pages

Build a working version of the journey to give testers something to react to.



Interviews

Speak to racers about their experience, hear their reactions to the existing and new experiences.

Three learning goals based off of 18 assumptions*.

LEARNING GOAL 01

How is trust built?

A gate condition. Before any connection lever can work, the platform, the causes and the claims need to feel credible enough to engage with seriously.

LEARNING GOAL 02

How do they connect with the causes?

Other segments arrive with a personal reason already attached. This audience doesn't. Which of the levers builds that connection from nothing?

LEARNING GOAL 03

How and when do we present the cause info?

Once a lever is known to work: what format carries it best, and where in the journey can it sit without repeating the drop in completion rate HIA saw last time cause information appeared early?

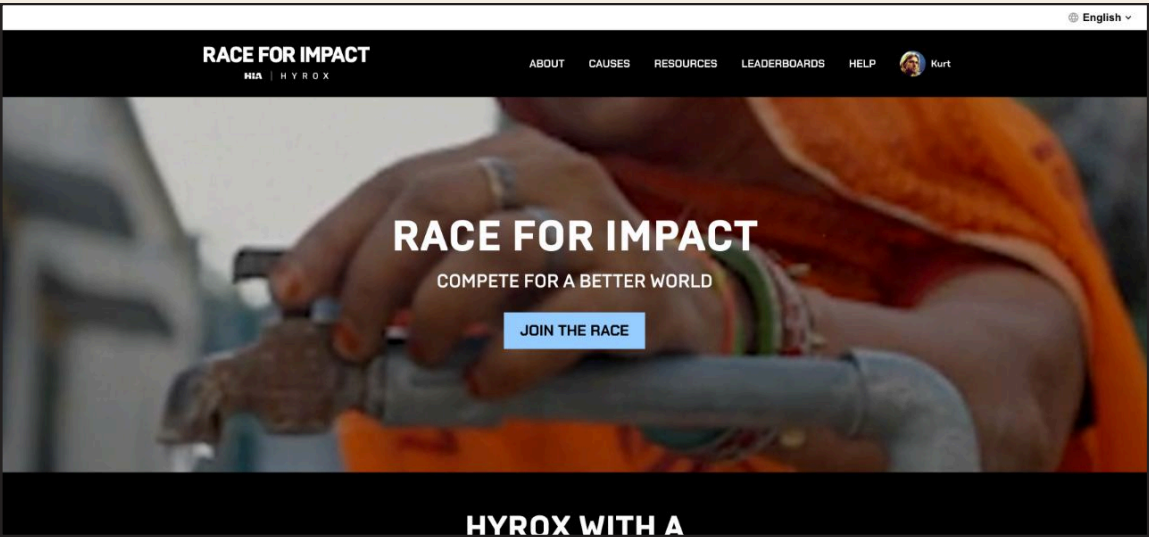
*FULL 18 ASSUMPTIONS IN THE APPENDIX.

Three passes over the same journey: what they remembered, what's really there, and what could be. Comparing the three shows the gap between what HIA is saying and what racers are taking in.



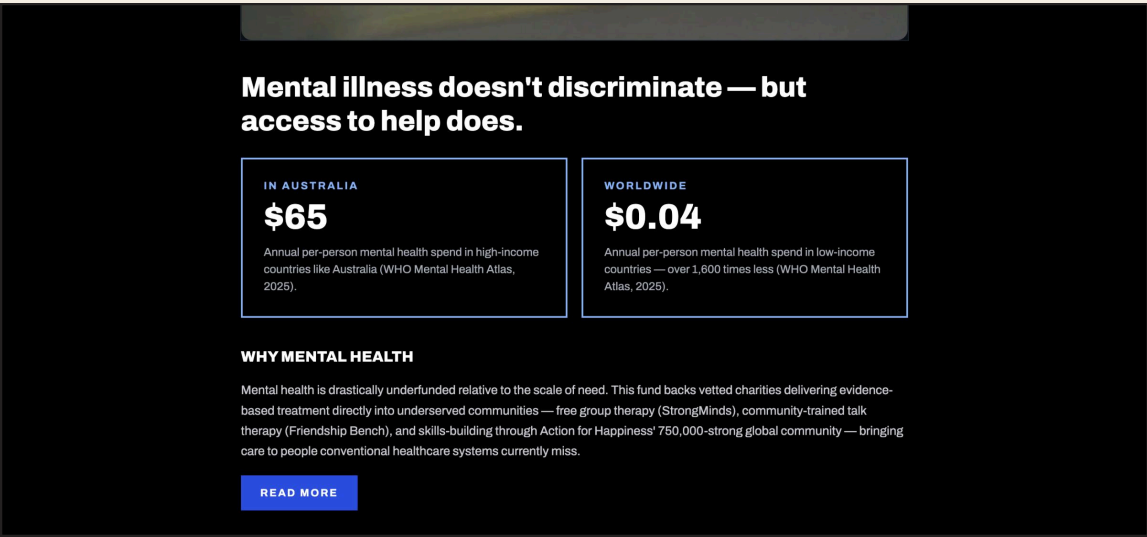
Experience recall

What racers remembered of their own sign-up, unprompted — what they saw, what they took in, what they'd already forgotten.



Existing journey reaction

Walking the live pages together and hearing what actually registers, what's misread, and what gets skipped.



Prototype reaction

Reactions to the redesigned experience, with the levers built in — testing whether the things we think build connection actually do.

An interactive prototype of the cause-selection journey for all five causes: a headline problem statement; a local stat with a global comparison; four first-person stories covering different connection levers; and three fundraising targets. Building it complete meant racers reacted to something that felt real rather than to a fragment or a hypothetical.

CHOOSE YOUR CAUSE

RACE FOR WHAT MATTERS TO YOU

RACING FOR:

MENTAL HEALTH ▾

1 IN 8 PEOPLE LIVE WITH A MENTAL HEALTH CONDITION,

Mental illness doesn't discriminate — but access to help does.

IN AUSTRALIA

\$65

Annual per-person mental health spend in high-income countries like Australia (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

WORLDWIDE

\$0.04

Annual per-person mental health spend in low-income countries — over 1,600 times less (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

Annual per-person mental health spend in high-income countries like Australia (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

Annual per-person mental health spend in low-income countries — over 1,600 times less (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

WHY MENTAL HEALTH

Mental health is drastically underfunded relative to the scale of need. This fund backs vetted charities delivering evidence-based treatment directly into underserved communities — free group therapy (StrongMinds), community-trained talk therapy (Friendship Bench), and skills-building through Action for Happiness' 750,000-strong global community — bringing care to people conventional healthcare systems currently miss.

READ MORE

HEAR FROM OTHER RACERS

74 RACERS ARE FUNDRAISING FOR MENTAL HEALTH AT HYROX MELBOURNE



SOPHIE LAURENT

I spent years thinking what I was feeling was just stress. It wasn't, and getting help changed everything. I fundraise for Mental Health because I know how much it matters to have somewhere to turn — and how many people still don't.



MARCUS WEBB

My dad never had the language for what he was going through. I want the next generation — including my own kids — to grow up somewhere asking for help is just normal.



ANJA KOVAC

Training for HYROX has taught me more about managing my head than my body. Showing up on the hard days, pushing through when everything says stop — that's the same muscle mental health takes. I race to help more people build that muscle too.

CONTINUE TO YOUR GOAL

RACE FOR IMPACT

HIA | HYROX

[← BACK TO YOUR CAUSE](#)

CHOOSE YOUR GOAL

HIGHER GOALS = GREATER IMPACT

RACING FOR:

GLOBAL HEALTH ▾

FUNDRAISING GOAL:

\$808 ▾

\$500 (minimum)

improves 88 lives

\$568

improves 100 lives

\$808

\$1 for every million of the 808 million people living in extreme poverty worldwide

ENTER YOUR OWN

set any amount

ACTIVATE PROFILE

Impact figures use HIA's published rates. Fundraising minimum applies from \$500.

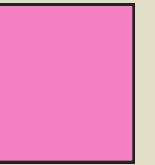
RACE FOR IMPACT

HIA | HYROX

14

03

Learnings



Racers don't go looking — you have to put it in front of them.

Racers choose fast — minutes, sometimes seconds — and don't go hunting for more. Several had never seen the Race for Impact site at all, and "who will you race for" sits low enough on the landing page to be missed entirely. Right now the cause content is either stumbled upon or arrives after the choice is already made.

Where racers did meet it at the point of choice, it changed things: which cause they picked, how connected they felt to it, and how confident they were the money would be well spent — one racer's confidence rose sharply on the strength of a single page.

What moved them at that moment was two things: understanding the problem, and understanding the impact their fundraising would have.

[on whether she'd seen the cause page before]

No, I haven't. And I'm sad about it.

– PARTICIPANT 01

I wish I saw [the cause info] first... we joined straight away without actually thinking of the fundraising part.

– PARTICIPANT 02

[the cause info] could be easily overlooked. I don't think it's prominent enough if you're trying to raise money.

– PARTICIPANT 03

✧ DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Give racers the information that matters at the moment it matters. At cause selection, that's the problem and the impact.

Racers don't go looking — you have to put it in front of them.

OPPORTUNITIES:

Add the cause content into the selection moment. This is the key moment to create connection, and is currently reduced to a single impact stat. Showing more information will build trust, connection and confidence for racers.

Raise "who will you race for" on the landing page. Racers said this was the most important information on the landing page and that it was too easy to miss. Is the role of the RFI page to point people towards tickets and explain how to fundraise? Or is it to sell the charity element?

Decide what the numbers should be steering. Sitting side by side at selection, numbers such as the lives impacted and count of fundraisers influenced the selection of which cause to choose, meaning we can steer outcomes. However, they were read in opposite directions, some toward the biggest number, one toward the smallest as a sign of neglect.

IN PRACTICE

CHOOSE YOUR CAUSE

RACE FOR WHAT MATTERS TO YOU

RACING FOR:

MENTAL HEALTH

1 IN 8 PEOPLE LIVE WITH A MENTAL HEALTH CONDITION,

Mental illness doesn't discriminate — but access to help does.

IN AUSTRALIA

\$65

Annual per-person mental health spend in high-income countries like Australia (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

WORLDWIDE

\$0.04

Annual per-person mental health spend in low-income countries — over 1,600 times less (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

Everyone has a connection. Our job is to help them realise it and deepen it.

Every racer has something to connect to: everyone knows someone who's struggled with their physical or mental health. The difference is whether they've made the link yet.

Most arrive having made it. They understand the cause at a high level, they've lived it or watched someone close to them live it, and that's enough to choose it. For them, reading up on the cause deepens it — the numbers, or a specific example like a chicken in a cage the size of an A4 sheet. That's what brings the problem to life, and it's what racers point to when they say they feel more connected to what they're doing.

For racers who haven't made the link, the same content prompts the realisation, and they build their own reason from it.

Stories build on that, but on connection to the race and the community more than to the cause itself.

I've had mental health issues in the past, so for me, I'm doing it with 150% of my heart. Whereas if I chose animal welfare, I know I would be 70, 80%.

– PARTICIPANT 01

[on the 1 in 3 women affected by violence statistic]

It's really easy to get caught up in our own day-to-day lives and it's one of those things you maybe forget about. So you see it again and you're struck with it.

– PARTICIPANT 05

Women's empowerment, yes, I'd love to stand for it, but women can also stand up for themselves. Animals have no one to speak for them.

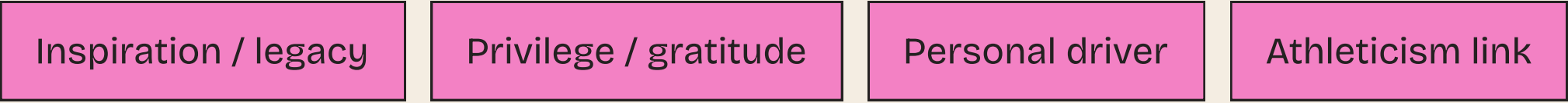
– PARTICIPANT 04

✧ DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Lead with the problem. And give racers a way to see themselves in it.

Different levers for different purposes.

USE THESE LEVERS:



TO



PRESENTED THROUGH



USE THESE LEVERS:



TO



PRESENTED THROUGH



Everyone has a connection. Our job is to help them realise it and deepen it.

OPPORTUNITIES:

Lead each cause with its most concrete, vivid detail. The physical specifics get repeated back; the framings around them get polite agreement.

Add stories. A small set of strong ones covering different ways in — personal experience, someone close to you, privilege, athleticism — so racers can find the one that fits their situation. The tested versions were from Melbourne racers, but locality wasn't what people responded to, so they needn't be local.

Test video as a format for those stories. Racers said they prefer video generally, but every story tested was written. Assume higher engagement and trust with video.

Explore how to support racers to write their own story. That sits at fundraising page setup rather than cause selection, but assume that getting them to create something personal rather than just copying the generic copy will build connection.

IN PRACTICE

Mental illness doesn't discriminate — but access to help does.

IN AUSTRALIA

\$65

Annual per-person mental health spend in high-income countries like Australia (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

WORLDWIDE

\$0.04

Annual per-person mental health spend in low-income countries — over 1,600 times less (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

WHY MENTAL HEALTH

Mental health is drastically underfunded relative to the scale of need. This fund backs vetted charities delivering evidence-based treatment directly into underserved communities — free group therapy (StrongMinds), community-trained talk therapy (Friendship Bench), and skills-building through Action for Happiness' 750,000-strong global community — bringing care to people conventional healthcare systems currently miss.

READ MORE

HEAR FROM OTHER RACERS

74 RACERS ARE FUNDRAISING FOR MENTAL HEALTH AT HYROX MELBOURNE



SOPHIE LAURENT

I spent years thinking what I was feeling was just stress. It wasn't, and getting help changed everything. I fundraise for Mental Health because I know how much it matters to have somewhere to turn — and how many people still don't.



MARCUS WEBB

My dad never had the language for what he was going through. I want the next generation — including my own kids — to grow up somewhere asking for help is just normal.



ANJA KOVAC

Training for HYROX has taught me more about managing my head than my body. Showing up on the hard days, pushing through when everything says stop — that's the same muscle mental health takes. I race to help more people build that muscle too.

20

Numbers are what racers remember — the more specific and personal, the better.

Numbers are what racers recalled and repeated back — but the problem and the impact do different jobs.

A specific number is what makes the problem land. These were the ones racers volunteered unprompted: a battery cage smaller than an A4 page; a woman killed every 10 minutes; one in three women experience violence. One tester even worked out live on the call into how many suicides there'd been while they'd been talking.

A personal number is what makes the fundraising feel worthwhile. What your target actually delivers. "\$690 improves 20 lives" was called a tangible way of seeing what your money does; "\$500 reaching 47 women" — not a lot of money, but nice to know you're having an impact.

General claims do neither. "High impact funds," "top charities," "10 to 1,000 times more effective" had no shared meaning, and were read backwards as often as not — high impact funds taken to mean even a small amount counts, top charities taken to mean the ones raising the most money.

[on how she decided between two causes]

It was like 93 for \$1000 in women's empowerment versus 3,400 animals for \$1000.

– PARTICIPANT 01

\$500, that's what, 15 lives? That's my village in Greece if you think about it. I'm impacting the whole village.

– PARTICIPANT 01

[on why her trust moved from 8 to 10]

The numbers. For me, numbers is statistics. That's what proves everything to me.

– PARTICIPANT 01

✦ DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Say it with numbers. Put a specific number on the problem and a personal one on the impact.

Numbers are what racers remember — the more specific and personal, the better.

OPPORTUNITIES:

Emphasise problem numbers. These are the stats racers connect most with; make them as obvious as possible so they can’t be missed.

Rewrite or drop "high impact funds" and "top charities." No shared meaning, read as the opposite of what's intended, and right now they're the only explanation racers get.

Test a reframed effectiveness claim. "Your money goes 10, 100, 1,000 times further" landed instantly when explained out loud. Worth testing against the current wording.

Use consistent units within a cause. Nine a day and every 43 seconds are the same fact in two shapes, and racers noticed.

IN PRACTICE

CHOOSE YOUR CAUSE

RACE FOR WHAT MATTERS TO YOU

RACING FOR:

MENTAL HEALTH ▾

1 IN 10 WITH A MENTAL HEALTH CONDITION,

Mental illness doesn't discriminate — but access to help does.

IN AUSTRALIA

\$65

Annual per-person mental health spend in high-income countries like Australia (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

WORLDWIDE

\$0.04

Annual per-person mental health spend in low-income countries — over 1,600 times less (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

Trust is borrowed from HYROX, and reinforced by evidence.

Racers trust Race for Impact without knowing who runs it, the reasoning being that HYROX wouldn't partner with someone untrustworthy. The trust is borrowed.

What reinforces it is evidence: named charities, cited sources, links to evaluators. Racers rarely click them, but they're reassured by seeing them there. One racer said seeing the charities listed made it concrete; another said removing them would confirm her doubts. Neither recognised any of the names.

For the few who do click, the evidence has to hold. The one racer who followed the evaluators link found a dead page and finished with less trust than he started.

No racer could name High Impact Athletes. That isn't costing trust — the halo covers it — but it means every racer finishes without knowing the organisation exists.

[on who runs Race for Impact

I don't know, is it HYROX?

– PARTICIPANT 01

HYROX is very well-known and trustworthy. They wouldn't collaborate with someone they couldn't trust.

– PARTICIPANT 04

I've got less trust now than I did when I started, because of that link not working. You're saying you've got experts, and I'm always going to say, who are they? If you can't show them to me, why would I trust you?

– PARTICIPANT 03

✧ DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Show your workings. The evidence reinforces trust for the many who never click, and has to hold up for the few who do.

Trust is borrowed from HYROX, and reinforced by evidence.

OPPORTUNITIES:

Keep the evidence visible. Named charities, sources, evaluator links all reassure by being there, even when no one’s heard of them and few will click on them.

Maintain links. For the ones who do click on links, a dead page costs more trust than the link ever built.

Explain who HIA are. Not a trust problem — racers trust it regardless. A brand one: every racer is a potential ongoing supporter and currently finishes unable to name who they raised for. Cheap to fix, and the foundation for anything HIA want to do in comms beyond this race.

IN PRACTICE

Mental illness doesn't discriminate — but access to help does.

IN AUSTRALIA

\$65

Annual per-person mental health spend in high-income countries like Australia (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

WORLDWIDE

\$0.04

Annual per-person mental health spend in low-income countries — over 1,600 times less (WHO Mental Health Atlas, 2025).

WHY MENTAL HEALTH

Mental health is drastically underfunded relative to the scale of need. This fund backs vetted charities delivering evidence-based treatment directly into underserved communities — free group therapy (StrongMinds), community-trained talk therapy (Friendship Bench), and skills-building through Action for Happiness' 750,000-strong global community — bringing care to people conventional healthcare systems currently miss.

READ MORE

HEAR FROM OTHER RACERS

74 RACERS ARE FUNDRAISING FOR MENTAL HEALTH AT HYROX MELBOURNE



SOPHIE LAURENT

I spent years thinking what I was feeling was just stress. It wasn't, and getting help changed everything. I fundraise for Mental Health because I know how much it matters to have somewhere to turn — and how many people still don't.



MARCUS WEBB

My dad never had the language for what he was going through. I want the next generation — including my own kids — to grow up somewhere asking for help is just normal.



ANJA KOVAC

Training for HYROX has taught me more about managing my head than my body. Showing up on the hard days, pushing through when everything says stop — that's the same muscle mental health takes. I race to help more people build that muscle too.

24

04

Next steps



Give racers the information they need to connect with the causes at the moment they most want it. Draw out the key stats, emphasise the problem, and begin to tell a story about the impact.

CAUSE SELECTION PAGE

- Split the flow into two steps: choose cause, then choose goal
- Surface the existing cause content on the cause-selection page
- Highlight the key problem stat for each cause

Extend that connection across the rest of the journey. Explain who HIA are and why the money goes further, keep the cause present in the emails after sign-up, and start building the stories that let racers see themselves in the cause.

CAUSE SELECTION PAGE

■ Source real fundraiser stories covering each connection lever

■ Produce each story in written and video form

■ Add fundraising goal ‘stories’ (minimum, round, stat-linked)

LANDING PAGE

■ Move "who will you race for" above the fold

■ Update explanation of HIA, HYROX and Race for Impact

■ Rewrite impact & effectiveness claims in terms racers understand

EMAILS

■ Weave key numbers into welcome email

■ Carry the key problem & impact metrics through the later emails

Turn connection into advocacy. Help racers put their reason into their own words for the people they're asking, and build the same understanding of what moves donors.

FUNDRAISING PAGE

■ Design a prompt to help racers write their page bio

DONORS

■ Run the same research approach with donors

00

Appendix



For Learning Goal 1: How is trust built?

#	ASSUMPTION	STATUS	EVIDENCE
01	HYROX's name may be doing the trust work alone. The HIA/HYROX relationship is barely explained; unclear whether racers need to understand it or just recognise the association.	SUPPORTED	No racer could name who runs Race for Impact. Grace: HYROX "wouldn't collaborate with someone they couldn't trust" — and gave 10/10 while saying she had no idea who ran it. Konstadina trusted it because it's global and long-running. Olivia rated HYROX and RFI the same. Anthony is the exception: his trust came from a mate, not the brand. But the "so what" needs inverting — the halo means independent credibility is less urgent for trust, and more urgent for brand: racers finish unable to name the organisation they raised for.
02	Naming specific charities builds credibility, even if unfamiliar.	SUPPORTED	Four of five cited the charities as what built confidence, and none recognised a single name. Sakura's counterfactual is the strongest evidence: without them, "that would prove my point in saying I don't know where the money would be going." Grace: "you wouldn't list specific places if you weren't going to give them the money." Olivia said seeing them mattered more to her than the lives-impacted figure. Anthony followed the links and started his own due diligence there.
03	Totals and leaderboards build trust, not just motivation. Untested whether per-cause totals read as reassuring or as guilt.	SUPPORTED	Konstadina named the leaderboard as proof of legitimacy: "this is obviously proving that there is people giving in this race." Grace: motivation ("I want to catch up to 13,000") and reassurance ("I'm not alone in it"). Anthony liked seeing faces and reasons. On the guilt risk: low per-cause numbers deterred nobody. Olivia said one racer would make her more determined; Grace said one would still be fine; Konstadina said a low number would make her choose it.
04	Impact and effectiveness claims are credible at the claimed level. Tested general ("10–1,000x"), specific ("£35 = one life"), personalised (tied to funds raised).	PARTLY SUPPORTED	General: no shared meaning. Sakura, "the one thing I did not understand." Anthony assumed it meant money raised. Grace guessed the same. Olivia, "I don't know what to make of that." Believed on faith by the credulous (Grace: "fully... you guys just say you know what you're doing") and rejected outright by the sceptic. Specific and personalised: both credible and both landed. But personalised opened a new question nothing answers — Anthony, "show me those 20 lives"; Olivia, is it sustained or one-off.
05	Fast cause picks reflect recognition, not defaulting. Determines whether the selection page should reinforce a fast match or interrupt it.	SUPPORTED	Grace decided in about two seconds and the reason held all session, became her Instagram pitch and her closing answer. Konstadina decided in "a second" with 10/10 confidence and strategic reasoning behind it. Sakura, five minutes. Only Olivia was slow — weeks — and she'd already read the cause content. Design implication runs against the original framing: don't interrupt the fast pick, but do make sure something worth reading is present at that moment.

For Learning Goal 2: How do they connect with the causes?

#	ASSUMPTION	STATUS	EVIDENCE
01	Problem empathy: feeling the issue itself builds connection.	SUPPORTED	The only lever that fired for every racer, on every cause. Grace on battery cages smaller than an A4 page — recited three separate times across 45 minutes, unprompted, and credited with her decision. Olivia on one in three: not new information, but "it's really easy to get caught up in our day-to-day lives... you see it again and you're struck with it." Anthony worked out live how many suicides occurred during the call. Konstadina quoted the 43-seconds figure back from memory.
02	Impact / effectiveness has emotional pull, not just credibility.	PARTLY SUPPORTED	Personal figures moved people: Konstadina worked out that \$500 is fifteen lives, "that's my village in Greece"; Anthony called it "a tangible way of putting, well, what money have I put in"; Olivia found \$500 reaching 47 women worth it despite the higher tier. But nobody carried a figure away unprompted, and Olivia said the charities mattered more to her than the number. Closes a decision; doesn't create a reason.
03	Athleticism link: "fit body, fit mind" builds connection. Prior evidence was Mental-Health-specific only.	SUPPORTED	One unprompted hit, on the wrong cause: Olivia argued that empowering women has to mean being okay with being strong, being athletic, not making yourself small — women's empowerment, not mental health. Konstadina linked the training itself to the cause: running while thinking "by running more, I'm saving someone." Never tested directly as page content, so this is racer-generated rather than lever-validated.
04	Location → global: local stats zoomed out build connection. Flagged as the weakest-evidenced lever going in.	SPLIT	Olivia, asked to pick one stat, chose the worldwide one. Sakura said knowing it went to low-income countries motivated her more. Konstadina valued that the problem exists in Australia too, not only in low-income countries. Anthony rejected the global framing outright: "I can't control what happens in other countries... I like Australian charities." No safe universal direction.
05	Privilege / gratitude builds connection, distinct from problem empathy.	SUPPORTED	Never landed as a stat. Landed twice as a story resonance: Grace chose Nadia ("we get to make the choice for our own body, they don't"); Olivia chose Lucas (brothers who never think twice about walking home). Both explicitly privilege framings, both self-selected.
06	Racer connection: seeing others' cause choices nudges cause selection.	REFUTED	Not one racer's choice would have changed at any number. Olivia said a count of one would make her more determined. Grace said one would be fine. Konstadina said a low number would make her pick it. Sakura would still have chosen mental health. Several found the mock numbers disappointingly low and it changed nothing. What it did do was signal community: Anthony wanted to recognise faces at the event; Grace felt "not alone in it."

For Learning Goal 3: How and when do we present the cause info?

#	ASSUMPTION	STATUS	EVIDENCE
01	Fundraisers actually encounter cause content before or during set-up. If false, none of LG1 or LG2 can be acted on.	REFUTED	Anthony had never seen the RFI site. Konstadina had never seen it — "and I'm sad about it." Sakura had seen the landing page but never the Causes page: "I do not look at any of these up here." Only Grace met the cause content at the right moment, via the activation email, and it decided her cause. Konstadina found the charity ticket itself only by scrolling past a sold-out standard ticket.
02	Delivery format needs testing per lever, not as one variable.	UNTESTED	Racers stated a video preference — Olivia said it's her preferred way to consume content, Sakura said she'd watch a video over reading a paragraph and remembered the yellow shoes from the cause video. But every story tested was written, so no format comparison was actually run. Carried forward as a recommendation.
03	Cause content pre-activation must stay optional. HIA saw activation drop when fuller content appeared early; fundraiser quality was never measured	UNTESTED	Racers consistently asked for it earlier: Konstadina would put the charity ticket at the top of the list, not the bottom; Sakura wanted "who will you race for" higher because she doesn't scroll. That's stated preference, not activation data. Needs an internal HIA data pull.
04	Cause selection is the highest-priority moment to test.	SUPPORTED	Every meaningful shift happened here. Sakura's confidence that the money would be well spent moved from 3 to 7–8 on the strength of one page. Konstadina's trust moved 8 → 10, and she said she'd have decided in one second rather than several had she seen it. Grace's entire connection formed here in about two seconds.
05	Later emails are lower-risk but likely lower-impact.	UNTESTED	No email content was tested. But the activation email was Grace's route to the cause content, and it's the one channel that reaches every racer repeatedly. Worth revisiting the "lower-impact" half of this assumption.
06	Fundraisers understand charity speak. Do fundraisers understand terms like "Global Health" and "Fund" on sight? Neither is explained anywhere in the journey.	REFUTED	"High impact funds" produced five different readings, most landing on "even a small amount counts" — roughly the opposite of the intended meaning. "Top charities" was read by two racers as the ones raising the most money. Grace read "High Impact Athletes" as athletes who have a high impact. Sakura thought Race for Impact was the donation.
06	The beneficiary voice is a more impactful way of presenting the problem.	UNTESTED	The four stories tested were fundraiser voices, not beneficiary voices. So the reclassification stands untested. Worth noting that fundraiser voices performed well: all four racers who reached them self-matched accurately to the story closest to their own life.